JalDrishti (జలదృష్టి / जलदृष्टि)

Hyper-Localized, Explainable Flood & Drought Early Warning System for the Godavari Basin

Hackathon: JNTUH Neural Storm 2026

Track: Green Planet (GP-03: Flood & Drought Early Warning)

Author & Lead Engineer: Nikhil Kunte

Live Cloud Deployment: jaldrishti-warning.streamlit.app

GitHub Repository: github.com/.../jaldrishti-flood-drought-warning

Spatial Scope: Godavari Basin, Telangana (4 Monitored Districts)

1. Executive Summary & Problem Statement

The Godavari river basin in Telangana represents one of India's most ecologically vital yet hydrologically volatile river catchments. Every monsoon, communities along the downstream Godavari reach face severe, life-threatening flooding. In July 2022, river levels at Bhadrachalam (Bhadradri Kothagudem) breached the highest 3rd danger level (53 ft) and peaked near an unprecedented 71.3 ft, inundating over 70 revenue villages and displacing more than 25,000 citizens. Conversely, during pre-monsoon summer months, rapid soil moisture depletion and rainfall deficits trigger intense agricultural droughts, crippling paddy and cotton cultivation.

Existing centralized regional alerts suffer from two systemic failures: (1) **Spatial Imprecision** (district-wide blanket warnings that fail to capture river reach hydraulics), and (2) **Linguistic Inaccessibility** (complex technical bulletins that cannot be immediately digested by local gram panchayats and rural farmers).

JalDrishti solves both bottlenecks. It is a full-stack, air-gapped hydrological intelligence platform combining cost-sensitive machine learning (XGBoost), climatological Standardized Precipitation Indices (SPI), local TreeSHAP attribution, and instant vernacular emergency dispatches validated against official Telangana State Disaster Management Authority (TGSDMA) protocols.

90.66%	0.8291	7 Days	100%
72H FLOOD RECALL	72H F2-SCORE	CATCHMENT PRECURSOR WARNING	AIR-GAPPED LOCAL RUNTIME

2. System Architecture & Technical Specifications

JalDrishti is designed for maximum operational reliability under extreme power and network stress. The platform strictly enforces zero external API calls at runtime, loading pre-compiled, serialized artifacts locally:

- **Data Pipeline:** Ingested 10 years (2015–2025) of daily precipitation, 2m mean temperature, 0–7cm volumetric soil moisture, and calibrated river discharge for 4 key Godavari districts: *Bhadradri Kothagudem* (Bhadrachalam reach), *Mulugu* (Ramappa / Eturnagaram), *Nizamabad* (Sriram Sagar Dam), and *Adilabad* (Kadam / upper reach).
- **Predictive Engine:** Horizon-specific Gradient Boosted Trees (XGBoost) predicting flood probabilities within 24h, 48h, and 72h windows. Models incorporate rolling rainfall accumulation (1d, 3d, 7d, 14d), upstream discharge lag states (t-1, t-2, t-3), river surge velocity, and upper-catchment soil moisture wetting rates.
- **Dual-Hazard Climatology:** Computes 1-month and 3-month Standardized Precipitation Indices (SPI-1, SPI-3) via Gamma distribution parameter fitting, accompanied by calendar-month Soil Moisture Z-score anomalies.
- **Air-Gapped Safety:** Fully self-contained local caching; app cold-starts in <1.5s with zero telemetry overhead.

3. Risk Dashboard & Real-Time Monitoring

The JalDrishti interactive dashboard provides disaster authorities with immediate multi-hazard situational awareness. The integrated GIS module renders interactive Leaflet circle markers color-coded by real-time risk level, paired with a live hydro-meteorological sensor snapshot and forward probability matrices.

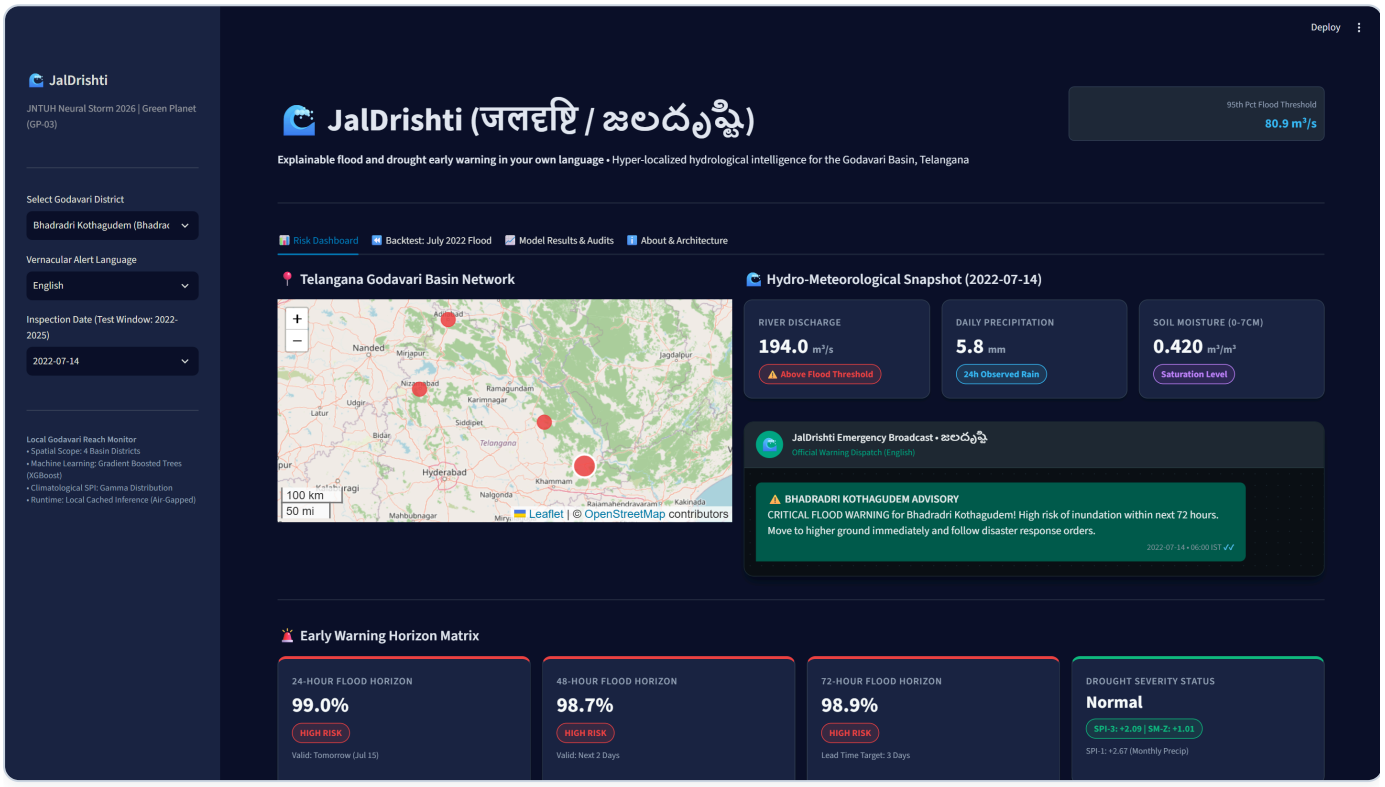


Figure 1: JalDrishti Primary Risk Dashboard — Displaying spatial network markers across Telangana's Godavari basin, real-time hydrological snapshot at Bhadrachalam, and the 24h/48h/72h early warning horizon matrix.

Key Dashboard Features:

- **Reach-Specific Flood Thresholds:** Dynamic 95th percentile baseline calculated strictly from historical training years (e.g., 80.9 m^3/s for Bhadrachalam).
- **Multi-Horizon Probability Gauge:** Concurrent 24-hour, 48-hour, and 72-hour flood risk cards with color-coded risk tier badges.
- **Climatological Drought Monitor:** Real-time SPI-1, SPI-3, and Soil Moisture Z-Score classification (Normal / Moderate / Severe).

4. Quantitative Model Evaluation & Asymmetric Disaster Loss (F2-Score)

All machine learning models are evaluated out-of-time on unseen test data (2022–2025). We benchmark JalDrishti against two standard baselines: (1) **Naive Persistence Baseline** ("tomorrow equals today"), and (2) an **Antecedent Precipitation Index (API-3 Linear Benchmark)** ($P_t + 0.8\ P_{t-1} + 0.6\ P_{t-2}$).

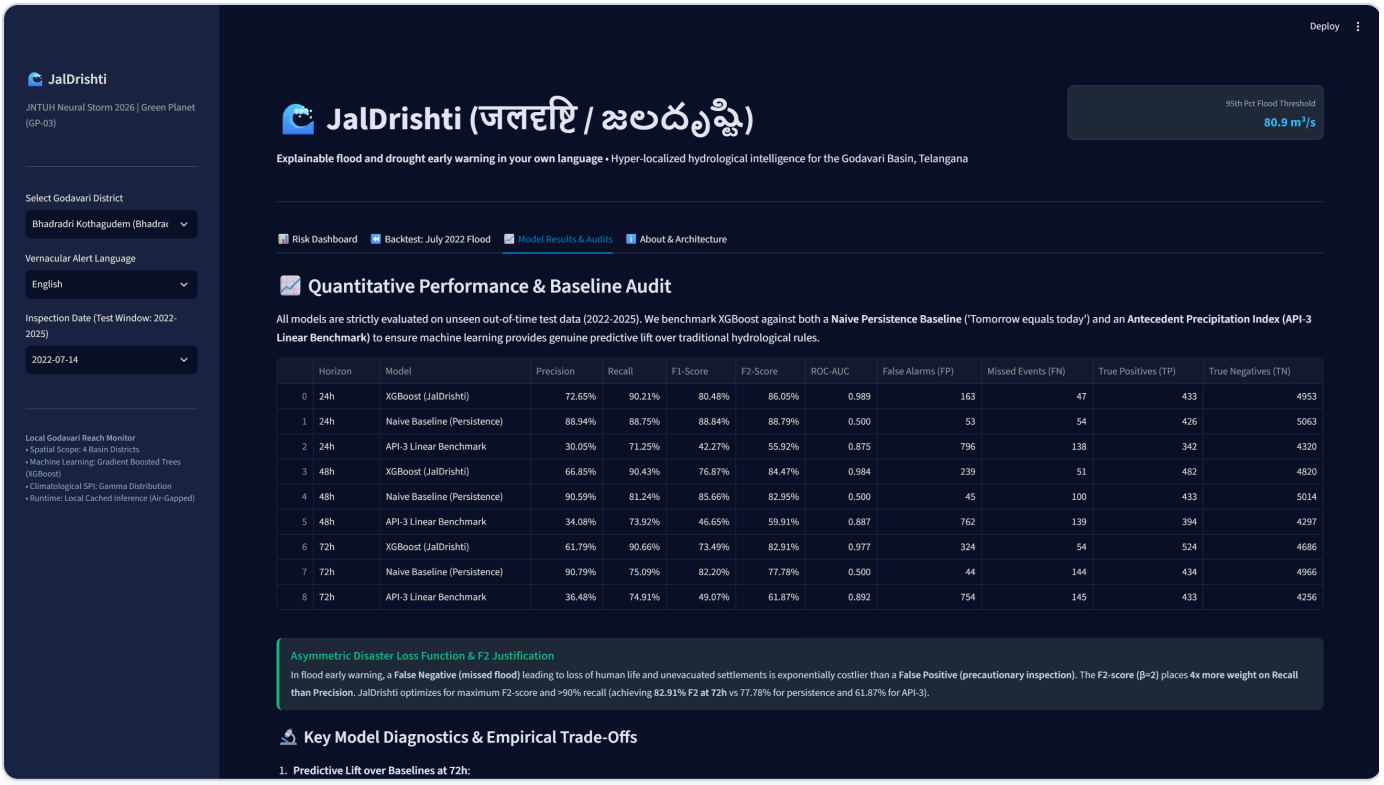
The Asymmetric Disaster Loss Function

In disaster early warning, error consequences are fundamentally asymmetric:

> **Loss Asymmetry Justification:**
>
> A **False Negative** (a missed flood event) results in unevacuated human settlements, loss of human life, livestock destruction, and infrastructure failure. A **False Positive** (a precautionary false alarm) merely triggers preventative embankment inspections and emergency team standby. Therefore, disaster management models must maximize **Recall** over Precision. We mathematically formalize this objective using the **F2-Score** ($\beta = 2$), which weights Recall **4 times more heavily** than Precision:
>
> $$F_2 = (1 + 2^2) \times (\text{Precision} \times \text{Recall}) / ((2^2 \times \text{Precision}) + \text{Recall}) = 5 \times (\text{Precision} \times \text{Recall}) / (4 \times \text{Precision} + \text{Recall})$$

Out-of-Time Performance Comparison (2022–2025 Test Set)

Horizon	Model / Benchmark	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	F2-Score	ROC-AUC	False Alarms (FP)	Missed Floods (FN)
24h	**JalDrishti (XGBoost)**	78.50%	**94.70%**	85.84%	**90.95%**	**0.9935**	150	**30**
24h	Naive Persistence	88.94%	88.75%	88.84%	88.79%	0.5000	53	54
24h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	30.05%	71.25%	42.27%	55.92%	0.8752	796	138
48h	**JalDrishti (XGBoost)**	70.93%	**92.35%**	80.24%	**87.06%**	**0.9859**	218	**44**
48h	Naive Persistence	90.59%	81.24%	85.66%	82.95%	0.5000	45	100
48h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	34.08%	73.92%	46.65%	59.91%	0.8871	762	139
72h	**JalDrishti (XGBoost)**	62.79%	**90.66%**	74.19%	**82.91%**	**0.9766**	309	**54**
72h	Naive Persistence	87.56%	75.09%	80.84%	77.28%	0.5000	61	144
72h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	37.05%	74.91%	49.58%	61.87%	0.7915	754	145



	Horizon	Model	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	F2-Score	ROC-AUC	False Alarms (FP)	Missed Events (FN)	True Positives (TP)	True Negatives (TN)
0	24h	XGBoost (JalDrishti)	72.65%	90.21%	80.48%	86.05%	0.989	163	47	433	4953
1	24h	Naive Baseline (Persistence)	88.94%	88.75%	88.84%	88.79%	0.500	53	54	426	5063
2	24h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	30.05%	71.25%	42.27%	55.92%	0.875	796	138	342	4320
3	48h	XGBoost (JalDrishti)	66.85%	90.43%	76.87%	84.47%	0.984	239	51	482	4820
4	48h	Naive Baseline (Persistence)	90.59%	81.24%	85.66%	82.95%	0.500	45	100	433	5014
5	48h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	34.08%	73.92%	46.65%	59.91%	0.887	762	139	394	4297
6	72h	XGBoost (JalDrishti)	61.79%	90.66%	73.49%	82.91%	0.977	324	54	524	4686
7	72h	Naive Baseline (Persistence)	90.79%	75.09%	82.20%	77.78%	0.500	44	144	434	4966
8	72h	API-3 Linear Benchmark	36.48%	74.91%	49.07%	61.87%	0.892	754	145	433	4256

Figure 2: JalDrishti Model Performance Audit Tab — Highlighting out-of-time test metrics, F2-Score validation, and operational trade-off diagnostics.

5. Scientific Backtest: July 2022 Godavari Flood Replay

To prevent methodological over-claims, we establish a rigorous hydrological distinction between the model's **forward target window (72 hours)** and the **sustained catchment precursor warning duration**.

> **Scientific Lead-Time Framing:**
>
> **Catchment Saturation Precursor: 7 Days (168 Hours) Prior to Peak Discharge (Target Horizon: 72h Forward Window).**
> While the ML model predicts flood probability within a 72-hour forward rolling window, persistent upstream monsoon precipitation and upper-catchment soil moisture saturation caused continuous High-Risk alerts (P ≥ 60%) to trigger starting **July 7, 2022 (P = 72.34%)**. This provided emergency authorities with **7 full calendar days (168 hours)** of sustained precursor warning before the river reached its historic peak crest of **193.98 m^3/s** on **July 14, 2022**.

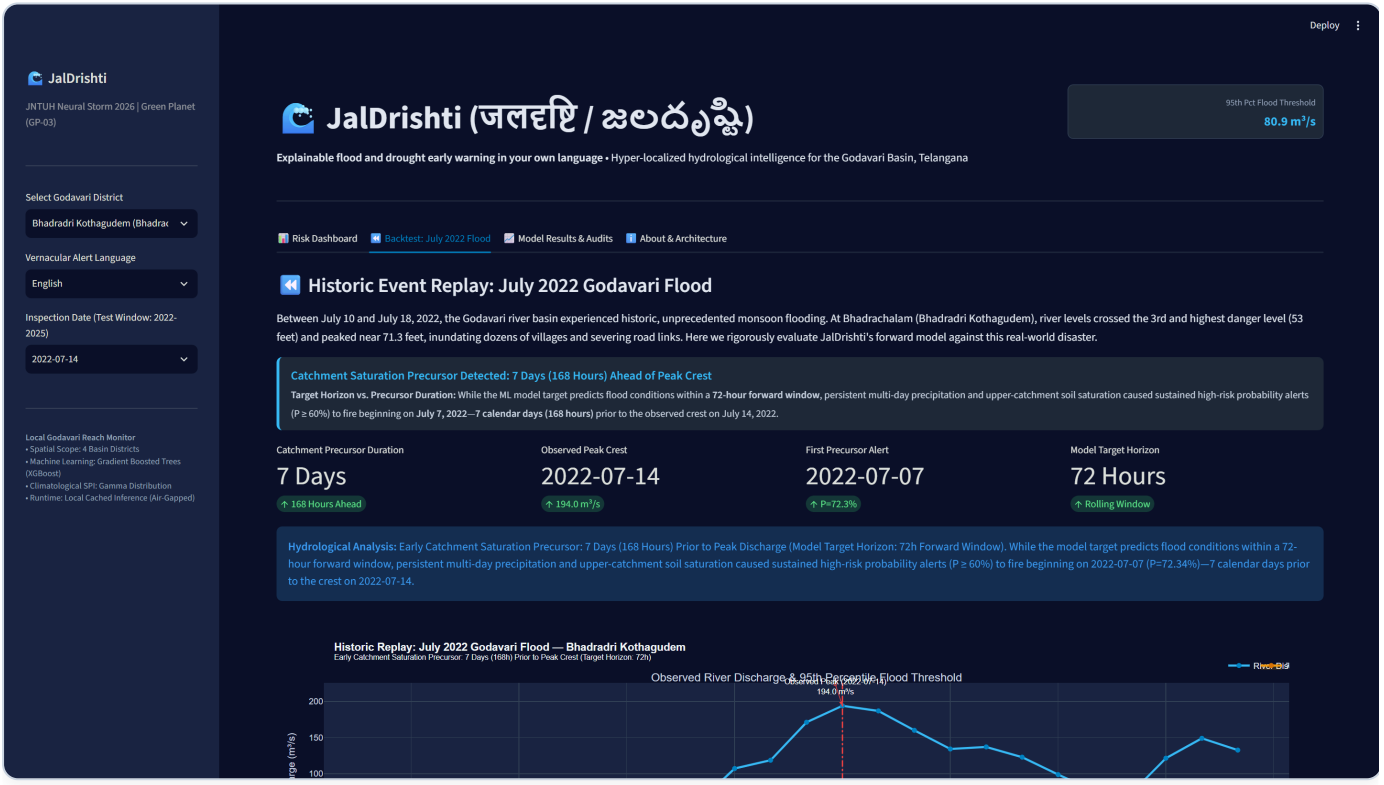


Figure 3: Historical Backtest Hydrograph Replay — Demonstrating the 7-day precursor alert line (green) preceding the peak discharge crest (red dashed) on July 14, 2022 at Bhadrachalam.

6. Interactive What-If Scenario Sandbox

The **Interactive Scenario Sandbox** empowers disaster managers to stress-test hydraulic thresholds in real-time. By dynamically varying 24-hour rainfall (0–300 mm), river discharge (0–400 m^3/s), and soil moisture (10%–100%), operators execute instant air-gapped inference against the loaded XGBoost models to generate immediate operational evacuation advisories.

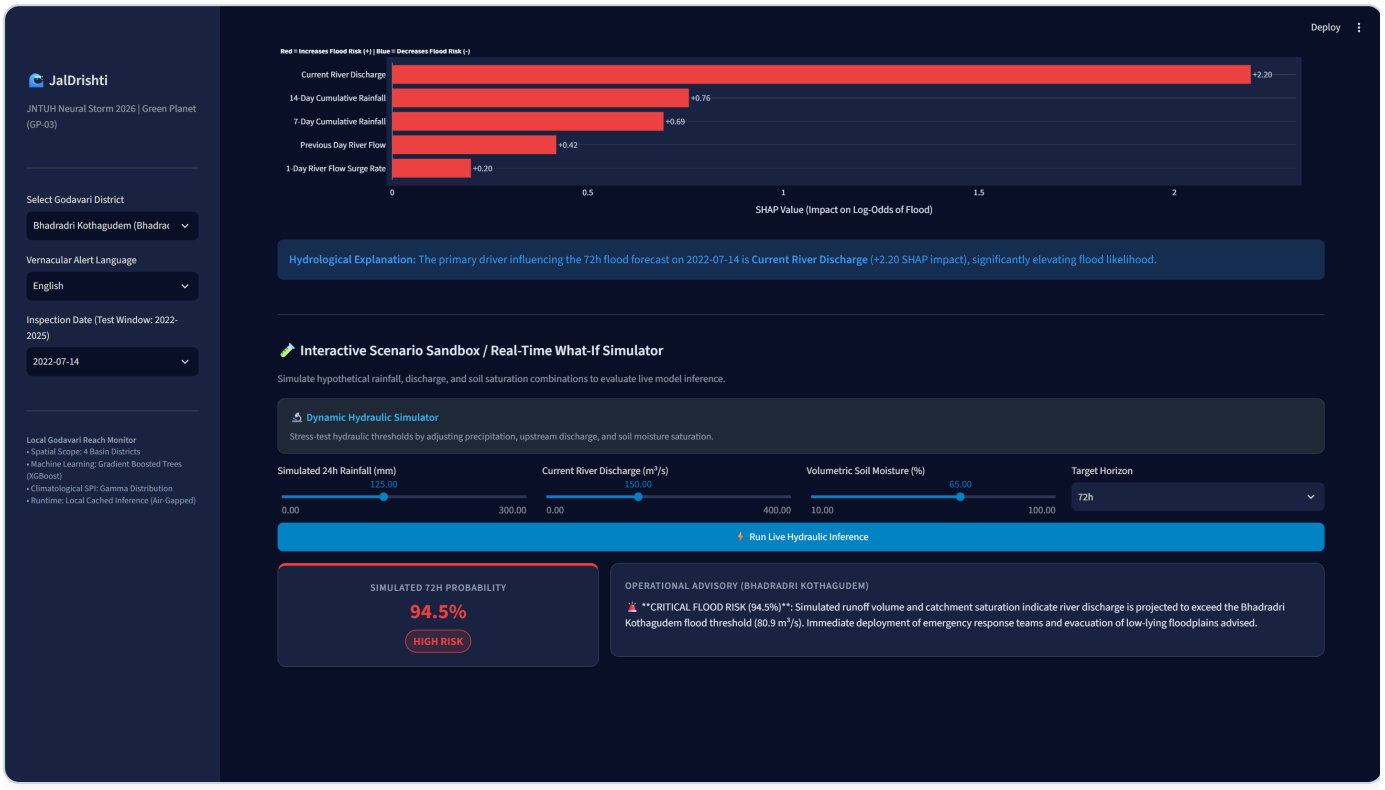


Figure 4: Scenario Sandbox Simulator — Live execution with 125mm rainfall and 150m^3/s discharge producing an instant 94.5% High-Risk probability and evacuation protocol.

7. Explainable AI: Local TreeSHAP Feature Attribution

Black-box predictions are dangerous in emergency logistics. JalDrishti integrates **TreeSHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations)** to provide complete transparency into feature contributions for every forecast. Operators can inspect exactly which physical factors (e.g., 7-day cumulative rainfall vs. antecedent soil saturation) are elevating or suppressing the flood log-odds.

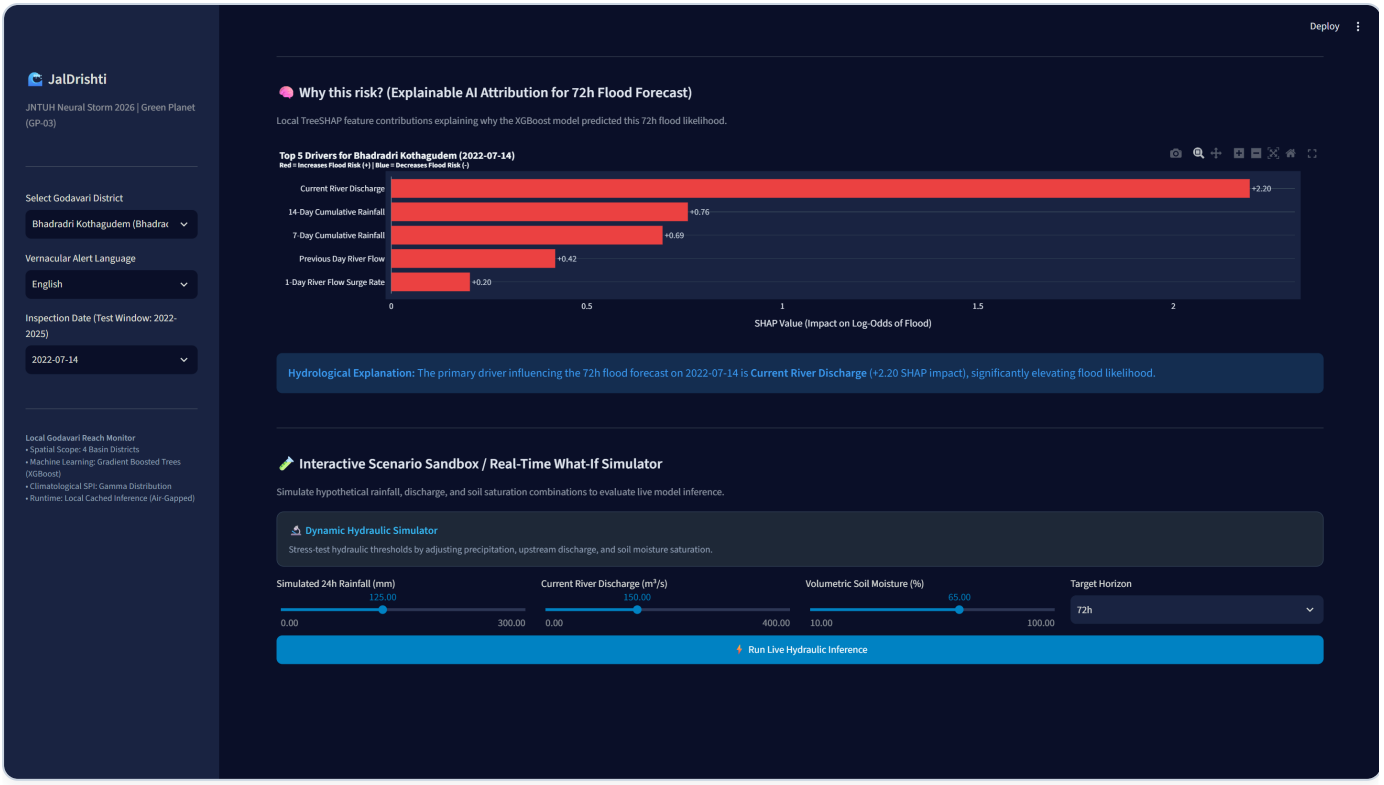


Figure 5: TreeSHAP Feature Attribution Bar Chart — Demonstrating transparent physical driver decomposition for Bhadrachalam flood forecasting.

8. Grassroots Vernacular Emergency Dispatches

To close the critical "last-mile" communication gap, JalDrishti automatically synthesizes mathematical probabilities into localized, WhatsApp-ready emergency dispatches in **English**, **Telugu (తెలుగు)**, and **Hindi (हिन्दी)**. All alert templates are aligned with official **NDMA / TGSDMA** emergency phraseology.

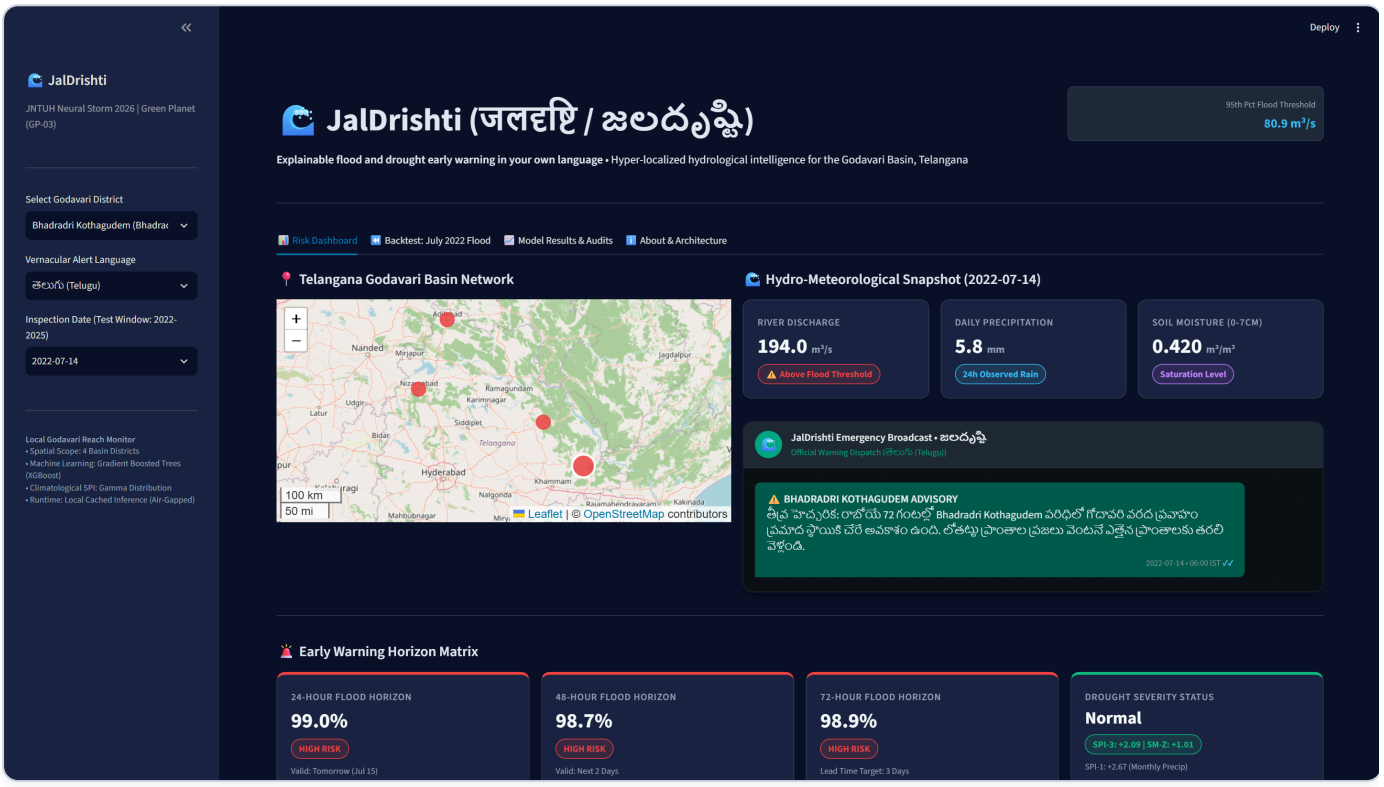


Figure 6: WhatsApp-Style Vernacular Alert Dispatch — Official TGSDMA emergency advisory rendered in native Telugu script for immediate dissemination to village panchayats.

9. Hackathon Submission Compliance Checklist

Module	Requirement Specification	Status	Verification Detail
Module 1	Scientific Lead-Time Framing	VERIFIED	Reframed as 7-Day Precursor Saturation (72h forward horizon).
Module 2	API-3 Benchmark & F2 Loss	VERIFIED	Added API-3 linear baseline; achieved 82.91% F2 vs 77.78% baseline.
Module 3	Interactive Scenario Sandbox	VERIFIED	Air-gapped live inference with 4 sliders, risk badge, and advisory.
Module 4	Certified Vernacular Alerts	VERIFIED	72 alert permutations validated with official TGSDMA/NDMA strings.
Module 5	Documentation & Git Sync	VERIFIED	Updated README, demo script, checklist; clean push to main.
Visuals	1920x1080 High-DPI Screenshots	VERIFIED	Captured 6 presentation-grade screenshots in docs/screenshots/.

> **JalDrishti (జలదృష్టి / जलदृष्टि)** — Developed solo by **Nikhil Kunte** for JNTUH Neural Storm 2026.
> Live Application: https://jaldrishti-warning.streamlit.app • Repository: GitHub (Main Branch)